

Tuesday, 28 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 30° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 28° 18°	MANCHESTER Overcast 25° 19°	GLASGOW Rain 20° 16°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-----------------------------------	----------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A funeral director who left people unburied in horrendous conditions has been described in court as breaching families' trust on an 'industrial scale'.

Robert Bush's funeral parlour was likened to a 'horror scene' at his sentencing hearing. Heartbreaking details emerged of the distress caused to grieving relatives.

CRIME · UK
- 2

The UK's iconic Jodrell Bank telescope, a symbol of British science, is now facing the axe due to proposed science cuts.

Astronomers are warning that losing the observatory would be devastating, tearing the heart out of UK science. It could also leave a generation of future scientists untrained.

SCIENCE · UK
- 3

Jewish students at UK universities have revealed that antisemitism on campus has felt 'relentless' in recent times.

Some students have spoken about having to hide their Jewish identity, fearing both physical and verbal abuse. It paints a concerning picture of life for many.

EDUCATION · UK
- 4

Amber heat health alerts have been issued for parts of the UK as another heatwave is set to sweep across the country.

Much of eastern England is under these alerts from Wednesday, with temperatures expected to climb into the mid-30s Celsius once again. Time to dig out the fans!

WEATHER · UK
- 5

Ukraine's President Zelensky made a significant visit to the UK, sending a clear message of continued support for his country.

He became the new prime minister's first international visitor since taking office. The meeting highlighted the ongoing strong ties between the two nations.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Darts sensation Luke Littler is set to take on everyday players in a unique live Netflix event later this year.**
 The 19-year-old champion will face a challenge from 20 amateur players in October. It's a chance for fans to see if they can beat the best!

ON AIR – Would you fancy your chances against Luke Littler? What's your go-to walk-on song?

TV · AUTUMN
- 2 A striking photograph of pop superstar Charli XCX has been acquired by the National Portrait Gallery.**
 The gallery described the artist as 'one of the defining cultural figures of her generation'. It's a big honour for the British singer.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Charli XCX track? Does a pop star's portrait belong in a national gallery?

ART · NOW
- 3 Stars and fans are celebrating British actor David Jonsson, who will play the new Black Panther in the third movie.**
 He's set to portray the son of T'Challa, King of Wakanda, in the highly anticipated superhero sequel. It's a massive role for the rising star.

ON AIR – Are you excited for a new Black Panther? Who would you cast as the next superhero?

FILM · FUTURE
- 4 Thousands of people across the world, including in Haworth, have been paying tribute to Kate Bush's classic 'Wuthering Heights'.**
 They've been re-creating her iconic 1978 music video, dressed in red, celebrating the enduring appeal of the song. It's become a global phenomenon.

ON AIR – Have you ever taken part in a 'Wuthering Heights' re-creation? What's your favourite iconic music video moment?

MUSIC · NOW
- 5 A new look at 'Love Island' suggests it offers fascinating insights into the changing face of dating in Britain.**
 From women making the first move to shifting relationship dynamics, the show has become a window into modern romance. It certainly gets people talking!

ON AIR – Do you think 'Love Island' truly reflects modern dating? What's the biggest change you've noticed in how people date?

TV · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 **Chelsea have opened talks to sign Brighton & Hove Albion striker Danny Welbeck, with the player reportedly keen on the move.**
The 35-year-old is a target for new manager Xabi Alonso at Stamford Bridge. It could be a significant signing for the Blues.
ON AIR – Is Danny Welbeck a good fit for Chelsea at 35? Which other players should Chelsea be targeting?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 2 **English football is set to trial a radical new rule this season to try and stamp out goalkeeper tactical timeouts.**
It's a move designed to keep the game flowing and prevent time-wasting. We'll see how it impacts matches.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of this new trial to stop goalkeepers wasting time? What other football rules would you change?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **The long-awaited heavyweight fight between British boxers Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua has moved a step closer.**
Both fighters won their respective warm-up bouts, clearing a major hurdle for the clash. Fans are desperate to see this one happen!
ON AIR – Who would you back in a fight between Fury and Joshua? Is this the biggest British boxing match in years?
BOXING · UK

- 4 **Trainer Andrew Balding had a phenomenal Sunday, winning £1.3 million in just two hours, including the prestigious King George.**
His horse Kalpana took UK racing's biggest prize fund, making it a day to remember for the British trainer. What a return!
ON AIR – Have you ever had a big win on the horses? What's your favourite British race meeting?
RACING · UK

- 5 **ITV has been confirmed as the official broadcaster for next year's Rugby World Cup in Australia.**
This extends their coverage of the tournament to a tenth successive edition, meaning fans can continue to enjoy the action. Great news for rugby lovers!
ON AIR – Are you looking forward to the Rugby World Cup next year? Which nation are you backing to win?
RUGBY · 2027

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that 'creative daydreaming' can significantly boost problem-solving skills.**
Researchers found that allowing your mind to wander creatively, rather than focusing intensely, can lead to fresh perspectives and innovative solutions to tricky problems. So, if you're stuck, perhaps a little day-dream might help!
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'writing physical letters' is making a heartwarming comeback.**
In our fast-paced digital world, people are rediscovering the joy of putting pen to paper to connect with loved ones. There's something truly special about receiving a handwritten note, isn't there?
- 3 Experts are highlighting the benefits of 'digital detoxes' for improving sleep quality.**
Stepping away from screens an hour or so before bed can help your brain wind down properly. It might just be the secret to a more restful night.
- 4 There's a growing trend for 'neighbourhood book swaps' in local communities.**
Residents are setting up little 'free libraries' or designated spots to share books, fostering a lovely sense of community and the joy of discovery without needing to buy new reads.
- 5 Scientists are exploring how 'mindful gardening' can reduce stress levels.**
Engaging with nature, even in a small way, by planting or tending to plants, has been shown to calm the mind and offer a peaceful escape from daily pressures. A little green therapy, perhaps?
- 6 The delightful hobby of 'collecting vintage board games' is seeing a surge in popularity.**
People are enjoying the nostalgia and unique artwork of classic games, often finding hidden gems from their childhoods. It's a lovely way to reconnect with simpler times.
- 7 A study found that 'listening to instrumental music' while working can enhance focus and productivity.**
Without distracting lyrics, certain types of instrumental tunes can create an ideal background for concentration. Perfect for getting those tasks done!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to find something we've lost, even though we know it rarely helps?

ANSWER: TALKING TO THE LOST ITEM, LIKE 'WHERE ARE YOU, REMOTE?'

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, fresh cup of coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING THE AROMA DEEPLY BEFORE THE FIRST SIP, ALMOST LIKE A PRE-COFFEE RITUAL!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'quirky family sayings' that only make sense within our own households, don't we?**
What's a funny or unusual phrase your family uses that would completely baffle an outsider?

- **Think about those 'little everyday moments' that just make you feel instantly content.**
Is it the first sip of your morning cuppa, the sound of rain on the window, or something else entirely? We'd love to hear what brings you those small bursts of happiness.

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies are able to taste with their antennae.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China is not a single continuous wall, but a collection of walls and fortifications.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, a hill in New Zealand.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- There are more active volcanoes under the sea than there are on land.
- Penguins are the only birds that can't fly but can swim.

On this day

Day 209 of the year, 156 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsa Muttathupadathu (Syro-Malabar Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Botvid; Christian feast day: Jaime Hilario Barbal; Christian feast day: Johann Sebastian Bach, George Frederick Handel, Henry Purcell (Episcopal Church commemoration). Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Jonathan Edwards, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1962 — Rachel Sweet, American singer, television writer, and actress
- 1951 — Ray Kennedy, English footballer (died 2021)
- 1993 — Harry Kane, English footballer
- 1958 — Michael Hitchcock, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1954 — Steve Morse, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1937 — Peter Duchin, American pianist and bandleader
- 1931 — Alan Brownjohn, English poet and author (died 2024)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1974 — Spetsgruppa A, Russia's elite special force, was formed.
- 2017 — Nawaz Sharif was disqualified from office for life by Supreme Court of Pakistan after finding him guilty of corruption charges.
- 1935 — First flight of the Boeing B-17 Flying Fortress.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1976 — The Tangshan earthquake measuring between 7.8 and 8.2 moment magnitude flattens Tangshan in the People's Republic of China, killing 242,769 and injuring 164,851.
- 2001 — Australian Ian Thorpe becomes the first swimmer to win six gold medals at a single World Championship meeting.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1965 — Vietnam War: U.S. president Lyndon B. Johnson announces his order to increase the number of United States troops in South Vietnam from 75,000 to 125,000.
- 1935 — First flight of the Boeing B-17 Flying Fortress.

- 2018 — Australian Wendy Tuck becomes the first female skipper to win the Clipper Round the World Yacht Race.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 210 of the year, 155 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Lazarus of Bethany; Christian feast day: Lupus of Troyes; Christian feast day: Martha of Bethany (Catholic, Anglican, and Lutheran Church); Christian feast day: Mary of Bethany. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Carl Cox, English DJ and producer
- 1924 — Robert Horton, American actor (died 2016)
- 1974 — Josh Radnor, American actor and musician
- 1952 — Joe Johnson, English snooker player and sportscaster
- 1933 — Robert Fuller, American actor and rancher
- 1966 — Stuart Lampitt, English cricketer
- 1923 — Gordon Mitchell, American bodybuilder and actor (died 2003)
- 1953 — Patti Scialfa, American musician

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1965 — Vietnam War: The first 4,000 101st Airborne Division paratroopers arrive in Vietnam, landing at Cam Ranh Bay.
- 1987 — British Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher and President of France François Mitterrand sign the agreement to build a tunnel under the English Channel (Channel Tunnel).
- 1996 — The child protection portion of the Communications Decency Act is struck down by a U.S. federal court as too broad.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2010 — An overloaded passenger ferry capsizes on the Kasai River in Bandundu Province, Democratic Republic of the Congo, resulting in at least 80 deaths.
- 2015 — The first piece of suspected debris from Malaysia Airlines Flight 370 is discovered on Réunion Island.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

23 JUL — 2 AUG Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10 Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)